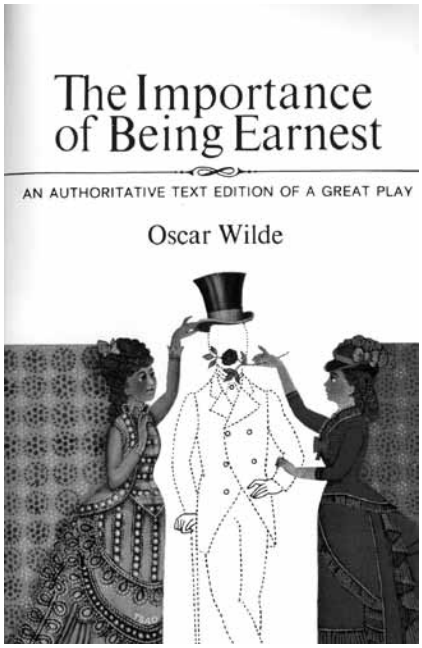
UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

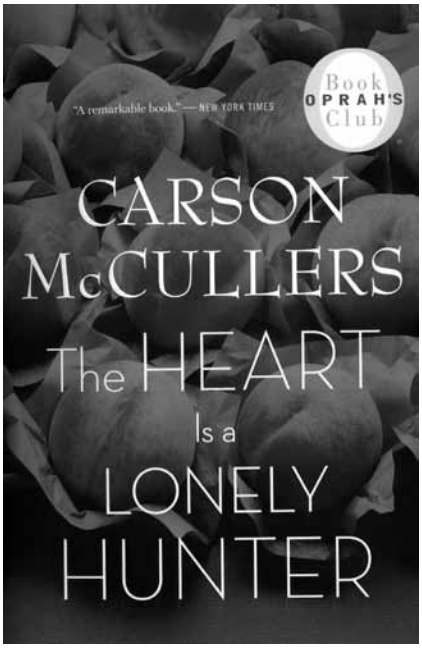
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

District 2 • 2013







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • District 2 • 2013

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The process by which an unhealthy emotional state produced by an imbalance of feelings is corrected and emotional health is restored, especially in terms of an audience's response to the fate of a tragic hero, is known as

   A) aporia.
   B) catharsis.
   C) hubris.
   D) mixed figures.
   E) peripety.

2. In prosody, the poetic foot composed of two accented syllables is

   A) anapest.
   B) iamb.
   C) pyrrhic.
   D) spondee.
   E) trochee.

3. A statement that although seemingly contradictory or absurd may actually be well founded or true is a(n)

   A) ambiguity.
   B) hyperbole.
   C) litotes.
   D) oxymoron.
   E) paradox.

4. A short narrative detailing the particulars of an interesting episode or event, usually involving the life of an important person and having an element of truth to it is a(n)

   A) anecdote.
   B) chronicle.
   C) fabliau.
   D) legend.
   E) romance.

5. The Romanian-born German poet and novelist who received the 2009 Nobel Prize for Literature for her work, including especially *The Hunger Angel*, which "depicts the landscape of the dispossessed," is

   A) Elfriede Jelinek.
   B) Gabriela Mistral.
   C) Herta Müller.
   D) Nelly Sachs.
   E) Wislawa Szymborska.

6. The total range of awareness and emotive-mental response of an individual, from the lowest pre-speech level to the highest fully articulated level of rational thought as presented in a flow of words constituting a narrative is called

   A) free indirect discourse.
   B) narratology.
   C) objective correlate.
   D) stream of consciousness.
   E) suspension of disbelief.

7. The assignment of something to a time when it was/is not in existence is

   A) anachronism.
   B) anaphora.
   C) chronological primitivism.
   D) successive patterning.
   E) transverse alliteration.

8. **Not** among the articulatory-acoustic auditory elements of lyric poetry known as melopoeia is

   A) alliteration.
   B) annotation.
   C) assonance.
   D) consonance.
   E) rhyme.

9. The group of late nineteenth-century Scottish writers whose work deals idealistically with village life in Scotland and in which dialect is an important element is

   A) Cockney School.
   B) Fleshly School of Poetry.
   C) Geneva School.
   D) Graveyard School.
   E) Kailyard School.

10. The literary period in English literature during which flourished John Fowles, Margaret Drabble, Harold Pinter, Tom Stoppard, Philip Larkin, and Ted Hughes is the

    A) Early Victorian Period.
    B) Late Victorian Period.
    C) Modernist Period.
    D) Postmodernist Period.
    E) Realistic Period.

11. The figure of speech that makes a brief reference to a historical or literary figure, event, or object that the author expects his or her audience to recognize is a(n)

A) allusion.
B) digression.
C) inscape.
D) metaphor.
E) tableau.

12. The group of mid nineteenth-century British poets whose verse reflects contemporary discontent and unrest and whose style is marked by jerkiness and strained emphasis is the

A) Cockney School.
B) Lake School.
C) Martian School.
D) Satanic School.
E) Spasmodic School.

13. The philosophy that, while deviating from the philosophy of its namesake whose teachings reflect the art of making life happy, argues pleasure to be the highest goal and pain and emotional disturbance the greatest evil is

A) Calvinism.
B) Djangoism.
C) Epicureanism.
D) Philistinism.
E) Stoicism.

14. The Southern novelist and short story writer who received the 1955 and 1963 Pulitzer Prizes for Fiction for *The Fable* and *The Reivers*, respectively, is

A) William Faulkner.
B) Cormac McCarthy.
C) Larry McMurtry.
D) John Kennedy Toole.
E) Robert Penn Warren.

15. **Not** having an eponymic origin, an origin based on the name of a real or fictional character, is the term

A) Byronism.
B) euphemism.
C) grundyism.
D) malapropism.
E) spoonerism.

16. The term applied to the many forms in which human beings have given rhythmic expression to their most intense perceptions of the world, themselves, and the relation of the two is

A) anthology.
B) chrestomathy.
C) poetry.
D) rhapsody.
E) syncopation.

17. Widely admired in both Great Britain and the United States, the recipient of the 1996 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for her collection *The Dream of the Unified Field* is

A) Rita Dove.
B) Louise Glück.
C) Jorie Graham.
D) Sylvia Plath.
E) Natasha Trethewey.

18. The early eighteenth-century British author of *Robinson Crusoe*, *Roxana: The Fortunate Mistress*, the historical novel *The Journal of the Plague Year*, and the picaresque novel *Moll Flanders* is

A) Daniel Defoe.
B) Henry Fielding.
C) Samuel Richardson.
D) Tobias Smollett.
E) Jonathan Swift.

19. A pantomime performance used in a play, particularly the silent acting as it appears in Elizabethan drama, is called

A) comic relief.
B) dramatis personae.
C) dumb show.
D) mock drama.
E) tableau.

20. The class of literature specializing in bloodshed and violence is called

A) Blood and Thunder.
B) showing versus telling.
C) signifier and signified.
D) Storm and Stress.
E) *Sturm and Drang*.

21. The twentieth-century British-Indian author of several award-winning novels, including the controversial *The Satanic Verses*, and whose first major work, *Midnight's Children*, has recently been made into a 2013 Canadian best picture-nominated film, is

A) John M. Coetzee.
B) Naguib Mahfouz.
C) V. S. Naipaul.
D) Orhan Pamuk.
E) Salman Rushdie.

22. The group of American writers, born around 1900, who served in the First World War, many of whom then spent time in Paris and New York, reacting against certain tendencies of older writers in the 1920s, is known as the

A) Agrarians.
B) Beat Generation.
C) Fugitives.
D) Lost Generation.
E) Muckrakers.

23. **Not** among the plays written by the twentieth-century Presidential Medal of Freedom-honored (1980) American playwright Tennessee Williams is

A) *Cat on a Hot Tin Roof*.
B) *The Glass Menagerie*.
C) *The Night of the Iguana*.
D) *Strange Interlude*.
E) *A Streetcar Named Desire*.

24. Writing that reads the same from left to right and from right to left is called a(n)

A) acrostic.
B) boustrophedon.
C) mesostich.
D) palindrome.
E) telestich.

25. A humorous scene, incident, or speech in the course of a serious fiction or drama, introduced to provide relief from emotional intensity and to heighten the seriousness of the story, is called

A) burlesque.
B) comic relief.
C) gallows humor.
D) mockumentary.
E) travesty.

26. A cheaply printed, paperbound tale of adventure or detection—usually set during the Revolutionary War, Civil War, or on the frontier—dealing with either lurid crime or exemplary actions and originally selling at a very cheap price is called a

A) dime novel.
B) page-turner.
C) penny dreadful.
D) potboiler.
E) pulp magazine.

27. The Richard Rodgers-Oscar Hammerstein II-Joshua Logan musical that is based on James A. Michener's 1948 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction winner and which won the 1950 Pulitzer Prize for Drama is

A) "*August: Osage County*."
B) *Driving Miss Daisy*.
C) *Of Thee I Sing*.
D) *Rent*.
E) *South Pacific*.

28. Commonplace in literature and movies, the character serving as a mysterious look-alike is known as a(n)

A) braggadocio.
B) doppelgänger.
C) *femme fatale*.
D) ingénue.
E) twiner.

29. A play (usually in verse) designed to be read rather than acted is a

A) closet drama.
B) colloquy.
C) dumb show.
D) melodrama.
E) mime.

30. A large expensive handsome nonfiction volume, usually with many illustrations and an appealing dust jacket and too large for an ordinary bookshelf, is called a

A) chrestomathy.
B) coffee table book.
C) folio.
D) hornbook.
E) quarto.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Oscar Wilde's *The Importance of Being Earnest*.
Items 37-42 are associated with Carson McCullers's *The Heart Is a Lonely Hunter*.
Items 43-50 are associated with Samuel Taylor Coleridge's poetry (selected).

31. In Oscar Wilde's *The Importance of Being Earnest*, an early indication of upper-class disdain for the lower classes is made evident in Algy's remark, "I don't know that I am much interested in your family life," a statement directed at

A) Bunbury.
B) Chasuble.
C) Jack.
D) Lane.
E) Merriman.

32. When Jack admits, "It is the first time in my life that I have ever been reduced to such a painful position, and I am really quite inexperienced in doing anything of the kind," he is referring to having to

A) eat cake instead of muffins.
B) tell a lie.
C) tell his aunt that there are no cucumber sandwiches.
D) tell someone that he loves her.
E) tell the truth.

33. The date on which Cecily and Algy's engagement was set is

A) April Fools' Day.
B) Boxing Day.
C) Halloween.
D) New Year's Day.
E) Valentine's Day.

34. The origin of John Worthing's surname is directly associated with a

A) brand of English muffins.
B) first-class train ticket.
C) hotel in Tunbridge Wells.
D) manufacturer of cigarette cases.
E) type of lady's handbag.

35. Lady Bracknell's comment, "The general was essentially a man of peace, except in his domestic life," reverberates with

A) gasconade.
B) hyperbole.
C) irony.
D) stichomythia.
E) tautology.

36. Speaking "frankly" and declaring, "I am not in favour of long engagements. They give people the opportunity of finding out each other's character before marriage, which I think is never advisable," is

A) Lady Augusta Bracknell.
B) Reverend Canon Chasuble.
C) The Honorable Gwendolen Fairfax.
D) Miss Laetitia Prism.
E) Mr. John Worthing.

37. In Carson McCullers's *The Heart Is a Lonely Hunter*, the recurring question "When a person knows and can't make the others understand, what does he do?" is actually voiced by

A) Jake Blount.
B) Biff Brannon.
C) Benedict Copeland.
D) Mick Kelly.
E) John Singer.

38. The letter addressed to Portia that reads, "I gone to Florada. Tell every body," was written by

A) Spiros Antonapoulos.
B) George Kelly.
C) Mick Kelly.
D) Ralph Kelly.
E) Harry Minowitz.

39. The gift Singer buys for Antonapoulos that arrives too late for Christmas is a

A) basket of fruit.
B) bus ticket to the asylum.
C) chess set.
D) moving-picture machine.
E) watch.

40. Troubled images of "Alice soaping in the bathtub. Mussolini's mug. Mick pulling the baby in a wagon. Blount's mouth. The face of Singer"

A) collect dust in Brannon's newspaper files.
B) crowd Biff's head.
C) decorate Mick's hatbox.
D) fill Brannon's photo album.
E) remind Mick of Mozart and Beethoven.

41. A minor argument regarding Singer's ethnicity occurs in a conversation between

A) Blount and Mick.
B) Brannon and Blount.
C) Copeland and Blount.
D) Mick and Portia.
E) Portia and her father.

42. The passage "And now, as a summer flower shatters in September, it was finished" describes the passing of the love Brannon had for

A) Alice.
B) Gyp.
C) John.
D) Madeline.
E) Mick.

Items 43-47 refer to Samuel Taylor Coleridge's

The Rime of the Ancient Mariner
(excerpted)

"Alone, alone, all, all alone,
Alone on a wide wide sea!
And never a saint took pity on
My soul in agony.

The many men, so beautiful!
And they all dead did lie:
And a thousand thousand slimy things
Lived on; and so did I.

I looked upon the rotting sea,
And drew my eyes away;
I looked upon the rotting deck,
And there the dead men lay.

I looked to heaven, and tried to pray;
But or ever a prayer had gusht,
A wicked whisper came, and made
My heart as dry as dust.

I closed my lids, and kept them close,
And the balls like pulses beat;
For the sky and the sea, and the sea and the sky
Lay dead like a load on my weary eye,
And the dead were at my feet.

The cold sweat melted from their limbs,
Nor rot nor reek did they:
The look with which they looked on me
Had never passed away.

An orphan's curse would drag to hell
A spirit from on high;
But oh! more horrible than that
Is the curse in a dead man's eye!
Seven days, seven nights, I saw that curse,
And yet I could not die.

The moving Moon went up the sky,
And no where did abide:
Softly she was going up,
And a star or two beside—

Her beams bemocked the sultry main,
Like April hoar-frost spread;
But where the ship's huge shadow lay,
The charmèd water burnt alway
A still and awful red.

Beyond the shadow of the ship,
I watched the water-snakes:
They moved in tracks of shining white,
And when they reared, the elfish light
Fell off in hoary flakes.

Within the shadow of the ship
I watched their rich attire:
Blue, glossy green, and velvet black,
They coiled and swam; and every track
Was a flash of golden fire.

O happy living things! no tongue
Their beauty might declare:
A spring of love gushed from my heart,
And I blessèd them unaware:
Sure my kind saint took pity on me,
And I blessed them unaware.

The self-same moment I could pray;
And from my neck so free
The Albatross fell off, and sank
Like lead into the sea."

43. The trope upon which these thirteen stanzas of Coleridge's "Rime" particularly depend is the

A) allusion.
B) hyperbole.
C) irony.
D) paradox.
E) simile.

44. Lines 232-44 feature the figure of repetition called

A) anaphora.
B) asyndeton.
C) homeoteleuton.
D) polyptoton.
E) polysyndeton.

45. Coleridge's albatross represents (an/the)
    A) birdlife.
    B) human life.
    C) orphan's curse.
    D) penance.
    E) power of the crossbow.

46. The Ancient Mariner prays because he is (a)
    A) snake lover.
    B) drowning.
    C) hoping to win the game of dice.
    D) scared to death.
    E) seeking release from guilt.

47. The albatross "from [his] neck so free / [. . .] fell off, and sank / Like lead in to the sea" because the Mariner
    A) envisions the hill, the kirk, and his own county.
    B) looks to heaven and tries to pray.
    C) recognizes the beauty of all nature's creatures.
    D) sees the moon rise above the sultry main.
    E) understands the loneliness of the sea.

Items 48-50 refer to Samuel Taylor Coleridge's

The Nightingale
(excerpted)

No cloud, no relique of the sunken day
Distinguishes the West, no long thin slip
Of sullen light, no obscure trembling hues.
Come, we will rest on this old mossy bridge!
You see the glimmer of the stream beneath,
But hear no murmuring: it flows silently.
O'er its soft bed of verdure. All is still.
A balmy night! and though the stars be dim,
Yet let us think upon the vernal showers
That gladden the green earth, and we shall find
A pleasure in the dimness of the stars.
And hark! the Nightingale begins its song,
'Most musical, most melancholy' bird!
A melancholy bird? Oh! idle thought!
In Nature there is nothing melancholy.
But some night-wandering man whose heart was pierced
With the remembrance of a grievous wrong,
Or slow distemper, or neglected love,
(And so, poor wretch! filled all things with himself,
And made all gentle sounds tell back the tale
Of his own sorrow) he, and such as he,
First named these notes a melancholy strain.
And many a poet echoes the conceit;
Poet who hath been building up the rhyme
When he had better far have stretched his limbs
Beside a brook in mossy forest-dell,
By sun or moon-light, to the influxes
Of shapes and sounds and shifting elements
Surrendering his whole spirit, of his song
And of his fame forgetful! so his fame
Should share in Nature's immortality,
A venerable thing! and so his song
Should make all Nature lovelier, and itself
Be loved like Nature! But 'twill not be so;
And youths and maidens most poetical,
Who lose the deepening twilights of the spring
In ball-rooms and hot theatres, they still
Full of meek sympathy must heave their sighs
O'er Philomela's pity-pleading strains.

48. The conceit that the "poet echoes" in Coleridge's "Nightingale" (line 23) is the
    A) bird's song as an expression of melancholy.
    B) immortality of nature.
    C) poet's blank verse.
    D) poet's surrendering.
    E) stream's silent murmuring.

49. Coleridge's argument is that neither the Nightingale nor nature is
    A) conceited.
    B) melancholy.
    C) poetic.
    D) sympathetic.
    E) venerable.

50. The time of year in which the speaker of the poem is encountering and reacting to the nightingale's song is
    A) autumn.
    B) spring.
    C) summer.
    D) winter.
    E) yuletide.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-54 refer to Dana Gioia's

Veterans' Cemetery

Veterans' Cemetery

The ceremonies of the day have ceased,
Abandoned to the ragged crow's parade.
The flags unravel in the caterpillar's feast.
The wreaths collapse onto the stones they shade.

How quietly doves gather by the gate
Like souls who have no heaven and no hell.
The patient grass reclaims its lost estate
Where one stone angel stands as sentinel.

The voices whispering in the burning leaves,
Faint and inhuman, what can they desire
When every season feeds upon the past,
And summer's green ignites the autumn's fire?

The afternoon's a single thread of light
Sewn through the tatters of a leafless willow,
As one by one the branches fade from sight,
And time curls up like paper turning yellow.

51. Dana Gioia's lyric poem "Veterans' Cemetery" relies most heavily on
A) auditory imagery.
B) gustatory imagery.
C) olfactory imagery.
D) tactile imagery.
E) visual imagery.

52. The second stanza's "patient grass reclaim[ing] its lost estate" speaks symbolically to the
A) beauty of a veterans' cemetery.
B) ceremonies' honoring of the veterans.
C) healing power of nature.
D) place where the stone angel stands.
E) regrowth of grass after doves have built their nests.

53. The poem's end rhyme is interrupted in the second stanza by an occurrence of what is best described as
A) assonance.
B) broken rhyme.
C) half rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) *rime riche*.

54. The references to nature—crows, caterpillars, doves, grass, and leaves—suggest, thematically, that
A) Dana Gioia, the poet, is a naturalist.
B) death is part of a natural cycle.
C) everything should be honored by burial.
D) poets and veterans have souls.
E) soldiers' deaths are natural.

Items 55-58 refer to Augusta Webster's

Mother and Daughter

She will not have it that my day wanes low,
Poor of the fire its drooping sun denies,
That on my brow the thin lines write good-byes
Which soon may be read plain for all to know,
Telling that I have done with youth's brave show;
Alas! and done with youth in heart and eyes,
With wonder and with far expectancies,
Save but to say "I knew such long ago."

She will not have it. Loverlike to me,
She with her happy gaze finds all that's best,
She sees this fair and that unfretted still,
And her own sunshine over all the rest:
So she half keeps me as she'd have me be,
And I forget to age, through her sweet will.

55. The form of Augusta Webster's "Mother and Daughter" is the
A) caudate sonnet.
B) English sonnet.
C) Italian sonnet.
D) Miltonic sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

56. The "day [that] wanes low" (line 1) is a(n)
A) allusion to the moon.
B) double entendre.
C) incantation to the sun.
D) metaphor representing life.
E) personification of the day.

57. "Loverlike" (line 9) is a(n)
A) hyperbole.
B) metaphor.
C) oxymoron.
D) simile.
E) zeugma.

58. The speaker throughout Webster's "Mother and Daughter" is (the)
A) boyfriend.
B) daughter.
C) God.
D) husband.
E) mother.

Items 59-62 refer to William Shakespeare's

Sonnet 71

No longer mourn for me when I am dead,
Than you shall hear the surly sullen bell
Give warning to the world that I am fled
From this vile world with vilest worms to dwell:
Nay if you read this line, remember not,
The hand that writ it, for I love you so,
That I in your sweet thoughts would be forgot,
If thinking on me then should make you woe.
O if (I say) you look upon this verse,
When I (perhaps) compounded am with clay,
Do not so much as my poor name rehearse;
But let your love even with my life decay.
Lest the wise world should look into your moan,
And mock you with me after I am gone.

59. "Compounded am with clay" (l. 10) is a reference to
A) alchemy.
B) being buried.
C) being memorialized as a statue.
D) Shakespeare's patron, Clay, Earl of Southhampton.
E) terra cotta poetry.

60. The words *vile* and *vilest* (line 4) exemplify
A) anadiplosis.
B) anaphora.
C) epanalepsis.
D) polyptoton.
E) tautology.

61. The word *moan* (line 13) is both
A) hyperbolic and oxymoronic.
B) onomatopoeic and hyperbolic.
C) onomatopoeic and metonymic.
D) oxymoronic and metonymic.
E) oxymoronic and redundant.

62. The speaker in the poem is asking the auditor to
A) avoid mocking him when he is gone.
B) begin a celebration of his death.
C) create a lasting memory of him.
D) forget him after he dies.
E) give a warning to the world that he has died.

Required tie-breaking essay prompt on the next page.

Items 63-65 refer to Seamus Heaney's

From the Frontier of Writing

The tightness and the nilness round that space
when the car stops in the road, the troops inspect
its make and number and, as one bends his face
towards your window, you catch sight of more
on a hill beyond, eyeing with intent
down cradled guns that hold you under cover
and everything is pure interrogation
until a rifle motions and you move
with guarded unconcerned acceleration—
a little emptier, a little spent
as always by that quiver in the self,
subjugated, yes, and obedient.
So you drive on to the frontier of writing
where it happens again. The guns on tripods;
the sergeant with his on-off mike repeating
data about you, waiting for the squawk
of clearance; the marksman training down
out of the sun upon you like a hawk.
And suddenly you're through, arraigned yet freed,
as if you'd passed from behind a waterfall
on the black current of a tarmac road
past armor-plated vehicles, out between
the posted soldiers flowing and receding
like tree shadows into the polished windscreen.

63. The form of Seamus Heaney's poem is the
A) caudate sonnet.
B) pantoum.
C) sestina.
D) sonnet cycle.
E) *terza rima*.

64. The comparison of a writer's waiting for "clearance" (line 17) to someone going through a military check-point is a(n)
A) analogy.
B) dead metaphor.
C) litotes.
D) paradox.
E) simile.

65. The sergeant (line 15) and the marksman (17) are
A) enemy troops.
B) enlisted men.
C) literary critics.
D) military personnel.
E) posted soldiers.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Samuel Taylor Coleridge's "An Invocation," and compose an essay that addresses Coleridge's focus on the importance of inspiration to the poet's imagination.

An Invocation

Sweet Muse! companion of my every hour!
Voice of my Joy! Sure soother of the sigh!
Now plume thy pinions,* now exert each power, **wings**
And fly to him who owns the candid* eye. **impartial, unbiased, pure**

And if a smile of Praise thy labour hail
(Well shall thy labours then my mind employ)
Fly fleetly back, sweet Muse! and with the tale
O'erspread my Features with a flush of Joy!

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest
District 2 • 2013
KEY

Page numbers are those associated with the *Handbook* 12e, the Mariner 2000 edition of *Heart*, and the Avon 1965 edition of *Earnest*.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History — **30 items (1 point each)**

1.	B	77	11.	A	14	21.	E	590-91
2.	D	452	12.	E	450	22.	D	279
3.	E	349	13.	C	177	23.	D	607
4.	A	26	14.	A	602-03	24.	D	347
5.	C	601	15.	B	186	25.	B	101
6.	D	457	16.	C	370	26.	A	144
7.	A	20	17.	C	605	27.	E	607
8.	B	29	18.	A	544-45	28.	B	151
9.	E	266	19.	C	159	29.	A	93
10.	D	375	20.	A	61	30.	B	95

Part 2: UIL Reading List — **20 items (2 points each)**

31.	D	28	38.	B	176	45.	D	
32.	E	86	39.	D	218	46.	E	
33.	E	74	40.	B	237	47.	C	
34.	B	47	41.	C	300	48.	A	
35.	C	108	42.	E	357	49.	B	ll. 13-15
36.	A	99	43.	E		50.	B	
37.	A	69	44.	A	24			

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism — **15 items (2 points each)**

51.	E		56.	D	294	61.	C	337/298
52.	C		57.	D	445	62.	D	
53.	C	226	58.	E		63.	E	475
54.	B		59.	B		64.	A	23
55.	C	260	60.	D	372	65.	C	

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Samuel Taylor Coleridge's "An Invocation"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of Coleridge's poem include

alliteration,
apostrophe,
envoy,
esemplastic power,
feminine rhyme,
iambic pentameter,
imagination,
inversion,
invocation,
metaphor,
metonymy,
muse,
quatrain,
syncope,
synecdoche, and
tone.

The brevity of and isolation of Coleridge's addressing the "Sweet Muse" suggests an envoy, perhaps for an ongoing body of work. The student might recognize this possibility in the appositive "companion of my every hour," which suggests both the poet's conscious life and his sleeping. The fullness of the relationship between the poet and the muse is further suggested in "Voice of my Joy! Sure soother of the sigh!" (line 2), a pairing of adulatory figurative phrases that gives direct responsibility for both uplifting joy and succor (whenever the metonymic sigh prevails) to the Sweet Muse.

The young contestant might concentrate on the role of the muse—here unspecified, but in the context of Coleridge's romantic focus on natural world, nature herself. The muse is both a companion in the creation of the poem (lines 1 and 6), which seems to be an exercise of the esemplastic power, and also something that helps the poet see the world with an impartial eye (line 4). The poet, while immersed in the inspiring vision, comes to see "the tale"—nature, perhaps including his poetry—as a unified whole.

The adventurous young writer might seek to compare the relatively abstract source of inspiration to which "An Invocation" is addressed to the more concrete source of inspiration in Coleridge's "Kubla Kahn," "the damsel with a dulcimer."